(c)*Mixed Hearing Loss* is a result of hearing impairments arising due to a combination of conductive and sensory neural defects.

Characteristics of a Child with Hearing Impairment:

- The child may be speech impaired besides having hearing impairment.
- They may have difficulty in learning language/vocabulary. It is an enormous challenge to learn to communicate in a language one cannot hear.

Special Needs of a Child with Hearing Impairment

Hearing defects cause a lot of problems ranging from language and vocabulary to comprehension and communication. Physical needs can be effectively taken care of by providing physical comfort. Parents can use play way techniques to help child.

Emotional and Social Needs:

Suspicion is almost the second nature with deaf children. Their social behaviour also needs to be improved and refined. Love and affection provide emotional security besides the much needed encouragement for better learning.

Educational Needs involve child's ability to understand the language. They learn to communicate through visual and manual means.

i. **Oral Method or Lip-Reading** is a slow method involving a lot of patience for the learner as well as the educator.
ii. **Manual Method or Sign Language** helps the child to communicate with gestures, cues and finger-spellings.

2.2.4.3 Orthopedic Impairment

A child with an affected limb is not able to fully perform the activities involving the use of bones, muscles and joints. Similar handicap is experienced by children with



a missing limb. Such children are known to be orthopedically crippled.

Characteristics of A Child With Affected / Missing Limb

- Physical defect leads to inferiority complex among young children.
- The feelings of inadequacy result in self-pity.
- The child often goes through psychological trauma because of discrepancy between his/her aspirations and the ability to perform.

Special Needs of Children with Missing / Affected Limbs

Physical Needs consist of being able to cope with one's daily routine. The attitude of parents should help the child do his/her duties independently rather than "do things for them". Use of special contraptions like calipers, shoes and artificial limbs along with proper training has yielded very good results. Use of crutches and wheel chair improves the mobility besides boosting their confidence.

Social and Emotional Needs. Children with affected limbs are very often left out of social group activities. The child may feel frustrated, dejected and neglected. Loving care and proper training to be independent and self-reliant are the basic needs of all handicapped children.

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